

a-service products. For example, OpenShift is a platform-as-a-service offering, and what it does is that people move to cloud computing and make almost an appliance of their applications. RHEL is used in a lot more situations like that with other tools like OpenShift. After that, if the customers run their application either in a virtualised environment or the cloud, they get a common operating system because they are using RHEL. So those are some of the things that we are working on. The beauty of the RHEL of the future really is the foundation of cloud computing as customers build private clouds and want to move to the public cloud in a hybrid situation—RHEL will be the foundation to do that.

Q Since you just mentioned Microsoft's market share, how do you view Microsoft's open source subsidiary?

Paul: From what I know of Microsoft's open source subsidiary, I don't think it has anything to do with markets here. What I know is that they are enabling a wholly owned subsidiary to focus on connectivity with open source projects. Frankly, I think that is a good thing. I think Microsoft is now acknowledging that open source is here to stay. It has said that it will focus on interoperability between open source and its own projects. That's a really good thing because what our customers are also asking is more connectivity with Microsoft. So, I think that it is a very good initiative.

Q How do you view your competition?

Paul: If you talk about the pure virtualisation environment, I think we are in a very good spot. In terms of the cloud, we have all the pieces. It takes multiple pieces to build a cloud. Clouds have been built from open source technologies. People build clouds out of virtualisation layers, out of operating systems, out of middleware or management components and manage all of that. We have all those pieces; in fact, we have established products in place with applications running in all those pieces. So, I think we are in a very good shape to build clouds on top of our products. VMware has Hypervisor. Applications don't run on Hypervisor. They run on operating systems and app services and VMware does not have either of those. So as we move to the cloud environment, I think VMware has some very serious holes in its product portfolio, as it tries to enable its customers moving to the cloud environment.

Q What does Red Hat do to increase the participation of the community?

Anuj: You need to look at the profile of Red Hat in two parts. One part is how we build and develop software and the second part is how we sell and go about our business. The development piece is a continuous engine and that's the open source part of what Red Hat does. For that, we need a community. We need to have a two-way dialogue. What we believe in is that those in the community between 14 years and 30 years are really the ones building the next generation of software and we have to involve them and we have to get close to them.



Paul Cormier, executive vice president and president, Products and Technologies, Red Hat Inc

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Paul: You cannot look at it as the American open source community or the Indian open source community, because that's what makes open source what it is. You get viewpoints from all over the world. It's not about the Indian viewpoint or the American viewpoint, it's about the best technical solution. The best technical solution could come from someone sitting in California or in Pune. So that is the beauty of open source. The development models that Microsoft and VMware use is that you get one person sitting in one company who gets to decide what goes in and what doesn't, what parts to fix and what not to. With this community, the whole world gets to see what is being worked on and anyone across the world with the best idea can get it done. That's why open source is so strong and why the technology here advances so much faster than with a traditional model. So, I wouldn't say that there is an Indian, American or any other open source community. It is the technology that people are interested in. 